DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE
PANJAB UNIVERSITY, CHANDIGARH.

Outlines of tests, syllabi and courses of reading in the subject of POLITICAL SCIENCE for M. Phil. Course (Semester System) for the year 2017-18, 2018-19, 2019-20

All papers are compulsory. The total credits for the M.Phil. Programme is 24 credits.

1st Semester	**Name of Paper**	**Credits: 12**
Paper I:	Philosophy of Social Science	4 Credits
Paper II:	Methods in Social Science	4 Credits
Papers III:	Reading and Writing in Social Sciences	4 Credits
2nd Semester		**Credits: 12**
Paper IV	Seminar Paper	4 credits
Paper V	Dissertation	8 credits
		Total Credits: 24

Chairperson,
Department of Political Science
Panjab University,
Chandigarh

INSTRUCTIONS FOR PAPER-SETTERS AND CANDIDATES

M. Phil. I Semester

Paper I and II

1. The question papers will consist of 60 marks each. 40 marks will be for Term Papers, Case Studies, Book Reviews related to the concerned papers.

2. The final written examination shall have 8 questions in all. The candidate is required to attempt any 4questions carrying 15 marks each, 1 from each Unit.

Paper III

1. This paper will focus more on a system of continuous evaluation and less on written examination. 80 marks will be for continuous evaluation through Literature Review (50), Book Review (15) and Writing Summaries/Abstracts (15). The Written Test will carry 20 marks.

2. In the written test, a candidate has to answer 2 out of 4 questions. The questions are meant to check on their critical reading skills. Each question will carry 10 marks.

M. Phil. II Semester

Paper IV

1. The Seminar paper will consist of 100 marks out of which 75 marks shall be for the submitted seminar paper and 25 marks on the viva-voce based on the seminar paper.

Paper V

1. The dissertation will be of 200 Marks out of which 150 marks would be based on evaluation of the dissertation and 50 marks would be for viva-voce test.

Chairperson,
Department of Political Science
Panjab University,
Chandigarh

M Phil Compulsory Paper 1

Philosophy of Social Sciences

Note: The final written examination shall have 8 questions in all. The candidate is required to attempt any 4questions carrying 15 marks each, 1 from each Unit.

Objective of the Course: This course aims at introducing the main themes in the philosophy of social sciences. This will familiarize them with the main debates over the nature of social science research.

Unit-I

The subject matter of Philosophy of Social Sciences
The Science Question: Is the study of society a science? Relationship with philosophy of science.
Objectivity and Value Neutrality

Unit-II

Methodological Naturalism, Positivism and Behaviouralism
Laws and Explanations: Social laws, casuality and predictions
Methodological Individualism and Reductionism
Intentionality, Rationality and Choice

Unit-III

Interpretation and understanding: Hermeneutics and Interpretive theory of culture
Social Constructivism: Social Facts and Social Norms Structures

Unit-IV

Networks and Agency: Structuralism, Functionalism, Materialism and Post Structuralism
Standpoint theory and Relativism

Readings:

Elster, Jon (2007) *Explaining Social Behavior. More Nuts and Bolts for the Social Sciences*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Flyvbjerg, Bent (2001) *Making Social Science Matter: Why social inquiry fails and how it cansucceed again*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Hollis, Martin (2012) *The Philosophy of Social Sciences: An Introduction*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press

Chairperson
Department of Political Science
Panjab University,
Chandigarh

-4-

Little, Daniel (1991) *Varieties of Social Explanation,* Colorado: Westview Press

Martin, Michael and McIntyre, Lee C (1994) *Readings in the Philosophy of Social Sciences*, Cambridge: MIT Press

Rosenberg, Alex (4th ed.) (2012)*Philosophy of Social Science*, Boulder, Colorado: Westview Press.

Shapiro, Ian, Smith, Rogers M and Masoud, Tarek E (eds) (2004) *Problems and Methods in the Study of Politics,* Cambridge: Cambridge University Press

Steel, Daniel &Guala, Francesco (eds.) (2011)*The Philosophy of Social Science Reader,* London: Routledge

Turner, Stephen A and Roth, Paul A (eds.) (2003)*The Blackwell Guide to the Philosophy of the Social Sciences*, Oxford: Blackwell.

M Phil Compulsory Paper II

Methods in Social Science

Note: The final written examination shall have 8 questions in all. The candidate is required to attempt any 4questions carrying 15 marks each, 1 from each Unit.

Objective of the Course: This course aims at equipping students with the knowledge and skills required to undertake systematic research. On completion of this course they should be able to develop their own research topics, frame research questions, and choose appropriate methodologies for data collection and analysis.

Unit-I

Preliminaries

Design of Social Science Research

Framing Research Problem and Key Questions

Concepts: Operationalisation and Measurement

Building Hypothesis

Selecting Case Studies

Comparative Analysis

Unit-II

Research Methods

Quantitative, Qualitative and Mixed Methods

Quantitative (Survey, Interviews and Questionnaire)

Chairperson
Department of Political Science
Panjab University,
Chandigarh

Qualitative (Ethnography, Oral narratives, Observation, Focus Group Discussion,Life Histories and Narratives)

Unit-III

Data : Types and Sources

Types of Data: Primary and Secondary

Sources of Data: Archival Sources (Documents, Diaries/Letters, Inscriptions, Photographs, Autobiographies, Paintings and Artifacts etc.), Official Statistics and Field Generated Data

Data Analysis **Unit-IV**

Data preparation, Data processing, Data interpretation and analysis

Quantitative data analysis: Descriptive and Inferential statistics

Qualitative data analysis: Discourse and Content analysis, Textual analysis

Readings

1. Black, Thomas R. 1999. *Doing quantitative research in the social sciences: an integrated approach to research design, measurement and statistics*. London: Sage Publications.
2. Blaikie, Norman W. H. 2003. *Analyzing quantitative data: from description to explanation*. London: Sage Publications.
3. Brady, Henry E. 2000. "Contributions of Survey Research to Political Science". *PS: Political Science and Politics*. 33 (1): 47-57.
4. Burgess, Robert G. 1984. *In the field: an introduction to field research*. Contemporary social research series, 8. London: Allen &Unwin.
5. Collier, David, and James E. Mahon. 1993. "Conceptual "Stretching" Revisited: Adapting Categories in Comparative Analysis". *American Political Science Review*. 87 (4): 845-855.
6. De Vaus, D. A. 2002. *Analyzing social science data*. London: Sage Publications.
7. Denzin, Norman K., and Yvonna S. Lincoln. 2005. *The sage handbook of qualitative research*. London: Sage Publications.
8. Desai, Vandana, and Robert B. Potter. 2006. *Doing development research*. London: SagePublications.
9. Dey, Ian. 2003. *Qualitative Data Analysis: A user friendly guide for social scientists*, London: Routledge.
10. Eckstein, Harry. 1975. Case study and theory in political science. (eds.) Fred Greenstein and Nelson Polsby, *Handbook of Political Science, Volume 7: Strategies of Inquiry*. Reading, MA.: Addison-Wesley.94-137

Chairperson,
Department of Political Science
Panjab University,
Chandigarh

11. Flyvbjerg, Bent. 2006. "Five Misunderstandings about Case-Study Research", *Qualitative Inquiry*, 12 (2): 219-45.
12. Frankfort-Nachmias, Chava, and David Nachmias. 1996.*Research methods in the social sciences*. London: Arnold.
13. George L. Alexander and Andrew Bennett. 2005.*Case Studies and Theory Development in the Social Sciences* Cambridge, Massachusetts: MIT Press
14. Gerring, John. 2007. *Case study research: principles and practices*. New York: Cambridge University Press.
15. Gerring, John. 2011. *Social Science Methodology: A Unified Framework*Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
16. Given, Lisa M. 2008. *The sage encyclopaedia of qualitative research methods.*Volumes 1 & 2. London: Sage Publications.
17. Goertz, Gary. 2006. *Social science concepts: a user's guide*. Princeton: Princeton University Press.
18. Grofman, Bernard. 2001. *Political science as puzzle solving:Interests, identities, and institutions in comparative politics*. Ann Arbor: University of Michigan Press.
19. Hollway, Wendy, and Tony Jefferson. 2000. *Doing qualitative research differently: free association, narrative and the interview method.* London: SAGE.
20. Holsti, Ole R. 1969. *Content analysis for the social sciences and humanities*. Reading, Mass: Addison-Wesley Pub. Co.
21. Johnson, Janet Buttolph, and Richard Joslyn. 1989. *Political science research methods*. New Delhi: Prentice-Hall of India.
22. King, Gary, Robert O. Keohane, and Sidney Verba. 1994.*Designing social inquiry scientific inference in qualitative research*. Princeton, N.J.: Princeton University Press.
23. Krippendorff, Klaus. 1980. *Content analysis: an introduction to its methodology*. Beverly Hills: Sage Publications.
24. Miles, Matthew B., and A. M. Huberman. 1994. *Qualitative data analysis: an expanded sourcebook*. London: Sage Publications.
25. *Porta Donatella della and Michael Keating*.2008. *Approaches and Methodologies in the Social Sciences: A Pluralist Perspective* Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
26. Punch, Keith and Keith Punch. 2003. *Survey research: the basics*. London: Sage Publications.
27. Silverman, David and Amir Marvasti.2008. *Doing Qualitative Research: A Comprehensive Guide*, London: SagePublications.
28. Thomas, George. 2005. "The Qualitative Foundations of Political Science Methodology". *Perspectives on Politics*. 3 (4): 855-866.
29. Trochim William, *Research methods knowledge base* (Trochim, William M. The Research Methods Knowledge Base, 2nd edition. Internet www page, at url: <http://www.socialresearchmethods.net/kb/> (version current as of October 20,2006)
30. Van Evera, Stephen. 1997. *Guide to methods for students of political science*. Ithaca: Cornell University Press.
31. Weber, Robert Philip. 1990. Basic content analysis, London: SagePublications

Chairperson
Department of Political Science
Panjab University,
Chandigarh

32. Wright, Daniel B. 1997. *Understanding statistics: an introduction for the social sciences*. London: Sage Publications.
33. Mouton, Johann and H C Marais. 1990. *Basic concepts in methodology of social sciences*. Pretoria: HSRC Publishers.
34. Creswell, W. John. 2007. *Qualitative inquiry and research design: choosing among five approaches*. London: Sage Publications.
35. Johnny Saldana. 2009. *The Coding Manual for Qualitative Researchers*. Sage Publications.
36. Melanie Birks 2011. *Grounded Theory: A Practical Guide*. Sage Publications.
37. John Gerring. 2011. *Social Science Methodology: A Unified Framework*. Cambridge Publications.
38. Herbert J. Rubin 2012. *Qualitative Interviewing: The Art of Hearing Data*. Sage Publications.
39. Bhattacherjee, Anol. (2012). *Social Science Research: Principles, Methods, and Practices*. Textbooks Collection. Global Text Project.
40. Stephen Gorard. 2013. *Research Design: Creating Robust Approaches for the Social Sciences*. Sage Publications.
41. Juliet M. Corbin 2014. 2nd editions) *Basics of Qualitative Research: Techniques and Procedures for Developing Grounded Theory*. Sage Publications.
42. Svend Brinkmann 2015. *Interviews: Learning the Craft of Qualitative Research Interviewing*. Sage Publications.
43. M. Thamilarasan. 2015. *Research Methodology for Social Sciences*. New Century Publications

Chairperson
Department of Political Science
Panjab University,
Chandigarh

M Phil Compulsory Paper 3

Reading and Writing in the Social Sciences

Note:1. In the written test, a candidate has to answer 2 out of 4 questions. The questions are meant to check on their critical reading skills. Each question will carry 10 marks.

2. 80 marks will be for continuous evaluation.The students will be evaluated on the basis of 1) Literature Review on a chosen theme (50%) 2) Test (20%) 3) Book Review (15%) 4) Writing Summary/Abstract (15%).

Objective of the Course: This course is aimed at developing critical reading and writing skills among students so that they can carry out research work.

Reading

1. Summarising the text
2. Discerning the research question, central argument, assumptions, evidence offered
3. Extracting author's contribution to the subject area
4. Identifying gaps and problems in method, literature survey, data, approaches to the problem, interpretation

Writing

1. Choosing between Formats - Structuring the paper, Elements of Organisation and Presentation
2. Literature Review
3. Methodology, Sources/Data
4. Citation, References, Bibliography
5. Ethics in the Profession and Research
6. Language- Common mistakes, Sentence construction.

Readings :

1. Brink-Budgen, Roy van den, 1999. *Critical Thinking for Students: How to Assess Arguments and Effectively Present Your Own,* How To Books Ltd: Oxford
2. Mayberry, Katherine, 2009. *Everyday Arguments: A Guide to Writing and Reading Effective Arguments,* Houghton Mifflin Company: Boston /New York
3. Weston, Anthony, 2009. *A Rule book for Arguments,* Hackett Publishing: Indiananpolis
4. Miller, Steven I, 1999. 'Teaching "Distinctions" to Undergraduates in the Philosophy of the Social Sciences', Analytic Teaching, Vol 18, No. 2
5. Resources available at Purdue Online Academic Lab.

http://owl.english.purdue.edu/owl/section/1/2/

Chairperson,
Department of Political Science
Panjab University,
Chandigarh